

Veterinary prices vs inflation — 20 markets, 2017–2025

WIDEST GAP

+65 pts

Bulgaria, vet prices over inflation

BELOW INFLATION

9 of 20

incl. Greece -16, Norway -9

SHARPEST MOVE

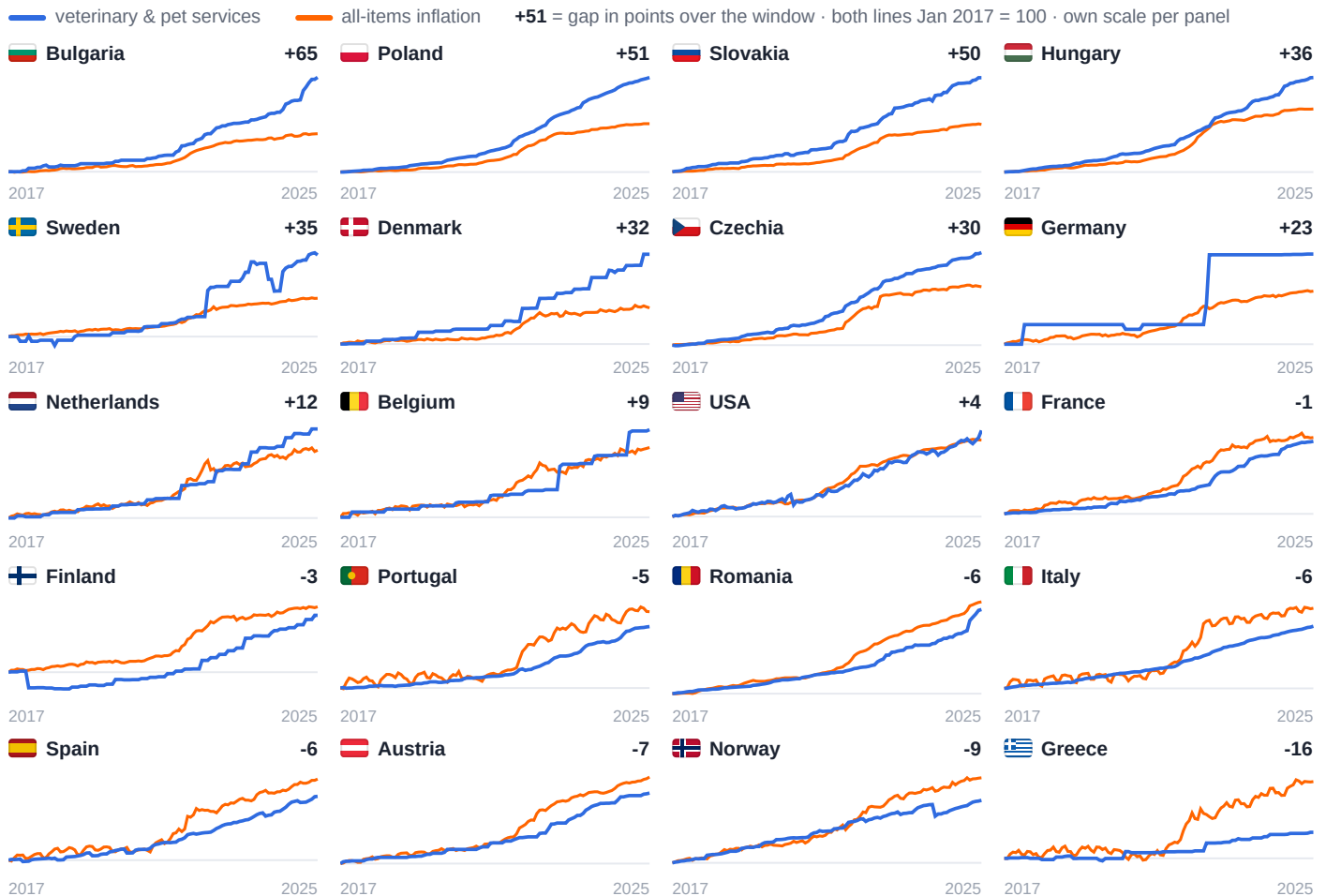
+24%

Germany, one month (Dec 2022)

UNITED STATES

+4 pts

mid-table, despite the narrative



WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

- **The gap is a geography.** Vet prices ran far ahead of inflation across Central, Northern and Eastern Europe (Bulgaria +65, Poland +51, Slovakia +50, Sweden +35, Denmark +32) and fell behind it across the South (Greece -16, Austria -7, Spain, Italy, Portugal).
- **Regulated prices jump, they don't drift.** Germany's vet fees are set by the national GOT fee ordinance: the index was flat for years, rose 24% in a single month when the November 2022 revision took effect, and has been flat since (155.3 vs 154.8 three years later).
- **The loudest story is mid-table.** The US, origin of the "vet costs are exploding" narrative, shows +4 points over inflation on the like-for-like basket — less than Denmark, Germany or Sweden.

SCOPE, EXCLUSIONS, SOURCES

Measure. Consumer price indices: what households pay for veterinary and other pet services, versus all-items inflation. Not farm animal health spending.

Excluded. Türkiye — publishes no vet-services price index (all-items HICP only). Ireland — vet series ends Dec 2023.

Known steps. Germany +24% (Dec 2022) and Sweden +18% (Oct 2022) are real repricings — fee-schedule revision and clinic-chain consolidation — not data breaks.

Sources. Eurostat prc_hicp_midx, monthly, 2015=100 — CP0935 veterinary and other services for pets vs CP00 all items. US: BLS CPI via FRED, monthly, NSA — CUUR0000SS62031 pet services incl. veterinary vs CPIAUCNS.